College of Design and Engineering

Guidelines for Preparation of UREx Report

Kindly consult with your supervisor on the best way to present the work in the report.

The following are generic report preparation guidelines suitable for most scientific research works.

Report Format

- Use A4-size paper and 2.5 cm margins on all sides.
- Report should be 10 to 20 pages long (excluding references and appendices) and should not contain unnecessary blank space. All pages in the main report shall be numbered from 1, 2, 3 etc. A hierarchical numbering scheme for section numbering shall be used i.e. use 1 for Section 1, 2 for Section 2, 1.1 for the Subsection 1 of Section 1, etc.
- For the main text, use Arial or Times Roman font (size 12), 1.5 line spacing. The text should be justified.
- Graphs and drawings in the report should be clear and easy to read.
- On the cover page, REx Fellows' name should appear as per NUS records. Do not use salutations i.e. Mr, Ms.

Report Content

Content that may be included, in sequential order, is listed below:

1 Cover page
2 Abstract
3 Preface and acknowledgments
4 Table of contents
5 Introduction, setting context, aims, research questions, conceptual framework
6 Theoretical perspectives, review of literature
7 Methodology, design of the study, and methods
8 Presentation of findings and data
9 Data analysis and discussion
10 Conclusion, conceptual and factual

References
Appendices (including additional info such as statistical tables, diagrams, illustrations)

<u>Sample Cover Page</u>

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (UREx)

PROJECT REPORT

Project Title

Name (Student Number)

Supervised by:

Name of Supervisor(s)

Department of Electrical Engineering, College of Design and Engineering

National University of Singapore

Abstract

In no more than 300 words, the abstract should provide readers with a good idea of what the report is about and enable them to determine their interest in reading the rest of the report. State the aims and outcomes of the research and the importance of the research contribution. Use keywords that reflect the nature and content of the project. The student may find it easier to write the abstract after writing the report body. Write in third person and passive language.

Preface and Acknowledgments

It is important to acknowledge and thank the contributions or assistance of others to the project. Keep your acknowledgements to one page.

Table of Contents

Use headings and sub-headings for each section. A main heading should be in bold, upper case and have one line of space above and below it. Secondary headings should be indented in 5 spaces and have one line of space above it but no space below it. Third grade heading may be used such that there is no full stop following it, it should have one line of space above it and leave 3 spaces before starting a text. References and appendices should also be listed under the table of contents.

Main Report

This includes items 5 to 10 indicated in the report content guidelines. The text of the main report shall be spaced 1.5 lines. Clear and concise articulation of research findings is critical. Presentation of information should be relevant, logical and organised. Including too much unnecessary details may reveal the student's challenge in distinguishing important issues from trivial ones. A good research student should be able to critique, with iterative developments, own research design and assumptions and evaluate alternative viewpoints critically. Maintain clear and continuous links between theory, method, and interpretation.

Citations and References

A good research student employs a variety of resources- books, journal articles, interviews, conference papers- to obtain answers to questions. In-text citations should be provided at the appropriate place to acknowledge the source of information used. At the end of the report, the citations should be compiled as References. For this report, References are to be listed in alphabetical order of the last names of the first authors and referred to in the text by the last name and the year of publication (e.g. Choi, 1975). Use the editor's name or the organisation's name when the author's name is absent. Abbreviate journal titles according to standard forms. You may want to style the reference list according to the examples below.

> Example:
>
> Choi, C.K. and Kim, S.H. (1989), "Coupled use of integration and nonconforming modes in improving quadratic plate element", Int. J. Num. Meth. Eng., Vol 28(4), 1909-1928.
>
> Choi, C.K. and Kwak, H.G. (1989), "Optimum RC member design with discrete sections", Proceedings of '89 ASCE Structures Congress, San Francisco.

Appendices

Appendices can be in single line spacing and in a smaller font size. Information of secondary importance and information whose inclusion would break the flow of the report (such as electronic data sheets, data dictionary etc.) should be placed in Appendices.